

Question 25 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Explain the role of feedback and counselling in an HRD system.

Introduction

Forms do not develop people; conversations do. Feedback gives information about behaviour and results. Counselling is a helping conversation about problems, choices and emotions, so that the employee can decide and change. In HRD they are the human process that makes appraisal, training and career systems work.

Detailed points

- 1. Feedback — role as information for improvement.** Specific, timely, behaviour-focused information: what was effective, what was not. Example: 'In yesterday's client meeting you interrupted twice, so we missed their concern' is usable. 'You are poor' is not. Feedback reduces the gap between self-image and reality.
- 2. Two-way feedback.** Employees also feed back on resources, unclear orders and organisational obstacles. This improves the system, not only the person, and matches the openness of HRD climate.
- 3. Counselling — meaning.** Notes define counselling as discussion of an emotional problem with the general objective of decreasing it; also as purposeful conversation in an understanding atmosphere so the person can choose among options. It deals with communication, emotions, and decision-making. Conditions may be job dissatisfaction, resistance to change, conflict, stress, or personal issues affecting work.
- 4. Functions of counselling.** Advise, reassure, communicate, release emotional tension, clarify thinking, reorient. Aims (Eisenberg & Delaney) include understanding self, setting achievable goals, coping, and positive self-regard. This is clearly developmental, not disciplinary scolding.
- 5. Link to appraisal and career.** Without counselling, appraisal is a signature on a form. Career counselling prevents unrealistic hopes and maps next steps. Feedback after training helps transfer.
- 6. Who should counsel.** Supervisors, specialists, professional counsellors. Managers need training; some cases need referral. Confidentiality is essential or the HRD system loses trust.
- 7. Process (simple five steps from notes).** Describe changed behaviour; get employee comments; agree on a solution; summarise and get commitment; follow up. Confine negatives to performance, not character attacks.
- 8. Climate role.** Skilled feedback and counselling build trust. Harsh or absent feedback destroys HRD climate. Thus their role is both individual development and system health.

Conclusion. *Feedback informs; counselling helps the person use that information and handle emotions/choices. Together they are the heart of HRD because development happens through dialogue.*